GLOSSARY A-Z

Bradycardia	-	A pulse rate of less than 60 per minute
Tachycardia	-	A pulse rate of more than 100 per minute
Systole	-	The phase of the cardiac cycle when the heart gets contract
Diastole	-	The phase of the cardiac cycle when the heart is at rest
Pericardium	-	The sac that encloses the heart; the heart's outermost layer
Purkinje fibers	-	Bundles of nerve tissues that allows the heart to conduct nerve impulses
Pulse	-	The rate of the heart this is documented as the number of heart beats per minute
Sinoatrial (SA) node	-	The natural heart pacemaker that controls the rate of the heart
Atrioventricular (AV)node	-	This node sends an electrical impulse to the bundle of His
Bundle of His	-	sends electrical impulse to Purkinje fibers
Cardiac arrhythmia, or dysrhythmia	-	Abnormal and irregular heart beats
Electrocardiogram	-	ECG, records the electrical activity of the heart and the heart's rhythm
Hypertension	-	High blood pressure
Hypotension	-	Low blood pressure
Angina or angina pectoris	-	Chest pain that results from the lack of adequate oxygen to the heart muscle. The lack of oxygen to the heart muscle is referred to as ischemia.
Myocardial infarction	-	Heart attack
Mastication	-	Chewing
Digestion	-	The breaking down of food particles into smaller particles and molecules
Taste buds	-	Taste sensors found on the upper surface of tongue
Parotid salivary gland	-	One of the salivary glands
Amylase	-	The digestive enzyme that is produced by the salivary glands in the saliva.
Peristalsis	-	Wave like involuntary muscular movements that move and propel food and fluids along the digestive tract
Chyme	-	Partially digested food in the stomach
Diarrhea	-	Loose and often difficult to control fecal evacuation
Constipation	-	The lack of a bowel movement and fecal evacuation
Fecal Impaction	-	The drying of stool in the intestines that cannot be evacuated

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